

ST. BAITHIN'S MASSES

22 nd August	Saturday	6pm	Mass
23 rd August	Sunday	12.15pm	Mass
25 th August	Tuesday	9.30am	Mass
26 th August	Wednesday	9.30am	Mass
27 th August	Thursday	7pm	Mass
28 th August	Friday	No Mass	
29 th August	Saturday	6pm	Pro-Populo
30 th August	Sunday	12.15pm	Patricia McBrearty RIP

NEWTOWNCUNNINGHAM MASSES

22 nd August	Saturday	7.30pm	Ann McGlinchey RIP
23 rd August	Sunday	11am	Hugh & Darren McDaid RIP
24 th August	Monday	9.30am	Mass
25 th August	Tuesday	7pm	Brigid Holmes RIP
26 th August	Wednesday	9.30am	Mass
27 th August	Thursday	No Mass	
29 th August	Saturday	7.30pm	George & Annie Rodgers and Marian Douglas RIP
30 th August	Sunday	11am	Adam Mulrine RIP

KILLEA MASSES

23 rd August	Sunday	9.30am	Pro-Populo
28 th August	Friday	7pm	John Lynch RIP (1 st Anniv)
30 th August	Sunday	9.30am	Mass

Recent Deaths: We pray for the soul of Lynn McGee (nee Brown), Mullenan Road, Derry and formerly of Dunmore, Carrigans. May her soul and all the souls of the faithful, departed rest in peace.

Anniversaries: John McCartney RIP. May his soul and all the souls of the faithful, departed rest in peace.

Prayer to St. Monica (Feast Day August 27th) – Patron of Mothers

Lord Jesus, you were moved by the prayers and tears of St. Monica and you gave the grace of conversion to St. Augustine her son. Touch our hearts and convert us from fear to love, from sickness to health and from conflict to peace of mind. Bless all mothers, living or dead, known or unknown, married, single or widowed. May their lives, their prayer and their Christian witness draw others to love you. **St. Monica pray for all children of all ages who cause their parents to worry.**

Emergency Number
087 3443600

WEEKLY NEWSLETTER

23rd August 2026 – Twenty-first Sunday of Ordinary Time

Fr Philip Kemmy, PP

Fr. Damien Nejad, CC

Office Address: Parochial House, Main Street,
Newtowncunningham

Step by Step through the Mass

The Liturgy of the Eucharist (Part 7)

The next small ritual that the priest carries out is known as the Lavabo – which derives from the Latin word for washing. In this ritual the priest has water poured over his hands by a server or he dips his hands into a bowl of water. This is not a hygiene ritual – though perhaps in the distant past it may be begun life as a necessary hand washing. In the distant past (as in some Missionary Lands to this day) not only the Bread and Wine (and offertory collection) are brought forward at this stage of the Mass, but also many other gifts of food, oil, meat or dairy produce are brought forward – often to be distributed later to the poor. This could be grubby business and would have necessitated that the priest, who received these gifts, had to wash his hands.

However, this is not the primary reason or purpose for this ritual. It takes its inspiration from the ritual washing that the Jewish Temple Priests carried out before they offered the sacrifices to God in the Temple. That ritual washing in the Old Testament Law of Moses was mandatory for priests every time they would offer a sacrifice. Its meaning was clearly a physical act seeking to communicate a spiritual reality. It was essential for maintaining the sanctity required to approach God and perform sacred duties. The hands of a person are symbolic of their actions – and so the washing of the hands by the priest in a sense reminded him (and those who witnessed it) that not all his works are good, holy and sinless, since he is a mortal man and therefore prone to sin. However, he washes his hands now to show that they are being prepared to do something good and holy – the offering of sacrifice to God. In the Old Testament, when the people saw a priest ritually wash his hands – they understood that a sacrifice was about to take place. For us at the Holy Sacrifice of the Mass, when we see the priest perform this simple ritual which could go unnoticed because it is so brief, we know that the reason for our gathering at the Church at this Mass is now, in a sense, moving up a gear – the Sacrifice of Jesus on Calvary is about to be made present in the here and now of our celebration of this Mass.

The priest accompanies this ritual action with a short prayer which he speaks almost inaudibly: “Wash me, O Lord, from my iniquity and cleanse me from my sin.” It reinforces the fact that this action is not about physical hygiene, but about being pure in heart and holy in soul – treating the Holy Things of God in a holy way and with holy fear of the Lord. It is in some way akin to a little last examination of conscience for the priest before he advances any further in the offering of Holy Mass.

Parish of Newtowncunningham & Killea

Email: office@newtownkilleeparish.ie
Website: www.newtownkilleeparish.ie

Sunday Collections: €2040; Feast of the Assumption: €490. Thank you for your continued generosity to your Parish.

Sacrament of Confession: All Saints Newtown every Saturday 10.30am – 11.30am.

Eucharistic Adoration: will take place on Wednesday in Newtown from 11am – 7pm and in Killea from 2pm – 6pm on Friday.

Eucharistic Adoration: will take place on Tuesday from 10am to 12 Noon.

Adoration and Holy Rosary, led by Fr. Damien on Thursdays from 6pm until 7pm in St. Baithin's Church. Come and pray for our community. Everyone welcome.

Adorers Needed from September: From early September, we intend to have Eucharistic Adoration every Thursday in St. Baithin's beginning at 1pm and finishing with Fr. Damien's guided Holy Hour from 6pm – 7pm. A **Minimum of 2 Adorers** are need for each hour. If you could cover one of the hours between 1pm and 6pm then please fill out one of the cards on the table in the porch and leave it in the sacristy in the coming days or weeks.

Items for the Parish Newsletter must be submitted to the Parish office no later than 12 Noon on a Thursday to be considered for the Newsletter

Mass for Expectant Families. Are you or someone you know pregnant? A Special Mass will be celebrated by Bishop Coll in St. Eunan's Cathedral, Letterkenny at **7pm on Tuesday 8th September** (Feast of Our Lady's Birthday).

ENCOUNTER COME & SEE: Have you heard about the **Encounter School of Ministry Course** but aren't sure what it's about or if it's for you? We invite you to 'Come & see' what it's about before you make your decision. Class will take place on Thursdays from 6.30pm (first half hour is prayer and worship) to 9.00pm beginning on **Thursday 3rd September at All Saints Church, Newtowncunningham**. Participants can attend up to 3 classes without committing to pay for the course. If a participant decides to enrol before the application deadline of October 1st, tuition fees will then be applied. If a participant decides not to continue, there is no obligation. More info or register here: <https://encounterschool.org/donegal/> or email donegal@encounterschool.org for more information.

Breast Cancer Awareness Month 2026 will take place this year from Thursday 1st – Saturday 31st October. For further information, please visit breastcancerresearch.ie or www.breastcancerireland.com

International Coffee Day 2026 takes place on Thursday 1st October. Please see www.internationalcoffeeday.org for further details.

Kitchen/Care Assistant required for Newtowncunningham Day Centre under the **Community Emploment Scheme (Ref. CES-2460526)**. To apply email: dmytro@letterkennychamber.com or contact your local intreo office using the above reference number.

ALONE has an information session regarding ALONE services at Newtowncunningham Credit Union on Friday 28th August from 10am til Noon.

RSA'S CHECK IT FITS SERVICE - Did you know it's the law that all children under 150cms or 36kgs must use a child car seat appropriate to their weight and height. In Ireland as many as 54% of child car seats are incorrectly fitted which can lead to serious injury or even death in a collision. You are invited on Wednesday 26th August to have your car seat checked beside the Smyths Toy Store, Letterkenny Retail Park.

Development Fund: €50. Thank you for your continued generosity to your Parish.

Sacrament of Confession: **St. Baithin's** each Saturday from 4.30 – 5.30pm.